

PRODCULATOR

PRODUCTION ANALYSIS REPORT · PRO

THE CARRICK LINE

SAMPLE REPORT ON A FICTIONAL SCREENPLAY, CREATED FOR DEMONSTRATION PURPOSES ONLY

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CONTENTS

What this report covers

01	Executive Summary	3
02	Script Intelligence	5
03	Production Location Strategy	6
04	Territory Analysis	8
05	Financial Analysis	11
06	Financial Readiness	13
07	Weather & Logistics	15
08	Tax Incentive Analysis	16
09	Grant & Funding Opportunities	18
10	Comparable Productions	19
11	Festival & Distributor Recommendations	20
12	Next Steps & Disclaimers	21

HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

COMPUTED

This figure comes directly from verified programme data and deterministic calculation. It is not an opinion or an AI estimate.

NARRATIVE

Written interpretation of the computed results. Explanation, never the source of a number.

BANKABLE

VERIFY FIRST

NOT BANKABLE

How dependable an incentive is for financing purposes.

Step-charts show how your budget becomes your net position. Each bar is one line of the calculation, and every chart carries a plain-English key.

01, EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Where this production makes the most financial sense to shoot

Every figure on this page is computed from verified programme data; the narrative explains it.

FORMAT	TOPE	SCALE	COMPLEXITY
Feature Film · Elevated Thriller	Cold, procedural, morally ambiguous	Mid-budget Feature · £15,000,000	High · 9 wk shoot (planned)

STORY UNDERSTANDING NARRATIVE

Script Overview

Set across a wet, unnamed British coastal town and a covert freight corridor running through Germany into the Caucasus, THE CARRICK LINE follows EVELYN CARRICK, a customs intelligence officer investigating a shipping manifest that does not add up, as she is drawn into a smuggling network operating under diplomatic cover. Her pursuit of a mid-level courier named REVAZ leads her from a Tbilisi freight yard to a Hamburg dockside interrogation, and finally back to the town she started in, where the network's UK contact turns out to be someone she has already trusted. The film is built around three set-piece sequences, a container-yard chase, a border-crossing interrogation, and a courtroom-adjacent confrontation, each requiring practical night exteriors and tightly controlled crowd logistics.

Primary Recommendation

The United Kingdom ranks first with a Financial Return Score of 74, rated Bankable. Under the UK Audio-Visual Expenditure Credit (AVEC), the estimated net rebate is 25.5% net on qualifying spend, returning approximately £2,868,150 on an £11,247,000 qualifying spend base, with payment expected within 3 to 6 months of completion. The coastal town sequences, which anchor the film's opening and closing acts, are script-locked to the UK, making it the natural creative and financial anchor for this production.

Second Territory

Germany scores 69 (Bankable) under the DFFF/German Federal Film Fund at a net rate of 25%, returning an estimated €3,750,000 on the qualifying Hamburg dockside sequences. Hamburg's working freight-port access and established night-exterior permitting make it the natural home for the interrogation sequence, and a Germany co-shoot complements the UK primary without duplicating soundstage costs.

Third Territory

Georgia scores 61 (Verify First) under the Georgian Film Incentive Programme at a 20% cash rebate, with payment in 6 to 9 months. Georgia becomes the right choice specifically for the Tbilisi freight-yard chase sequence, where the script calls for a genuine working rail-freight environment that is difficult and costly to double convincingly elsewhere. The rebate structure requires local production services registration, which should be initiated early given the 6 to 9 month payment window.

Production Complexity Snapshot

The script presents 104 scenes across 3 named international locations, with 6 stunt sequences (including one vehicular chase), 2 night-exterior crowd sequences, and one extended dialogue-driven interrogation sequence requiring specialist sound design. There is no VFX-heavy content; the primary technical demand is night-exterior lighting and practical vehicle stunt work.

Strategic Recommendations

The production's declared 9-week shoot leaves a workable but tight post-production runway against the completion date; producers should confirm the edit and sound-design schedule against the interrogation sequence's dialogue

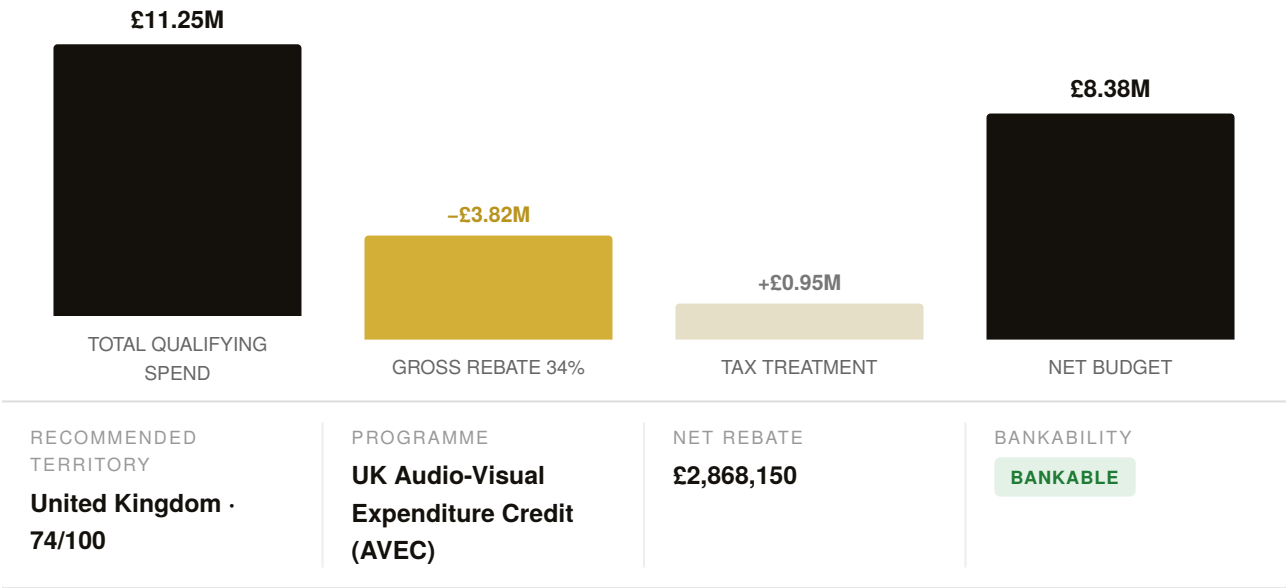
complexity before locking delivery dates. Georgia's 6 to 9 month payment window should be modelled into cash flow now rather than at financial close, and the Hamburg night-exterior permit application should be initiated at least 8 weeks ahead of the declared shoot window.

ESTIMATED NET BUDGET AFTER INCENTIVES, UNDER UK AUDIO-VISUAL EXPENDITURE CREDIT (AVEC)

£8,378,850 net of £2,868,150 rebate

On £11,247,000 qualifying spend at 25.5% net (34% gross, the gross rate applies before tax treatment).

WHERE THAT NUMBER COMES FROM, UNITED KINGDOM, N° 1 RANKED



02, SCRIPT INTELLIGENCE

What your script tells us

Two readings of the same document: one counted, one understood.

PARSED FROM YOUR SCRIPT

Est. shooting days, from the script	47 (about 9.4 wk; you planned 9)
Principal cast	Medium
Named international locations	3
Stunt sequences	6

STORY READING NARRATIVE

Elevated Thriller, cold and procedural in tone, with a morally ambiguous undercurrent, mid-budget feature film in scale. Production complexity is assessed as high, driven primarily by night-exterior logistics and vehicle stunt coordination rather than visual effects.

PRODUCTION CHALLENGES

- Night-exterior permits required in three territories, with lead times that vary significantly by municipality
- Working freight-yard access for the Tbilisi chase sequence requires coordination with an active rail operator

03, PRODUCTION LOCATION STRATEGY

Where the numbers point

3 territories, scored across six dimensions.

Cost Efficiency	Measures how far your budget stretches in this territory relative to the global average for a comparable production.
Crew Depth	Whether the territory can staff all key departments without significant importation of experienced crew.
Infrastructure	The physical production ecosystem: soundstages, equipment houses, post-production facilities and logistics.
Incentive Strength	The financial value of the available rebate or tax credit, factoring in rate, qualifying spend, caps and access complexity.
Currency Advantage	Purchasing power of the production's budget currency in the shoot territory at report generation time.
Incentive Reliability	Whether the incentive is bankable: whether a lender will advance funds against it before payout.

HOW WE SCORE

Each territory is scored out of 100 based on six weighted dimensions. Full picture mode uses these weights: Incentive Strength 30% · Incentive Reliability 15% · Cost Efficiency 20% · Currency Advantage 15% · Crew Depth 10% · Infrastructure 10%.

N°1 · RECOMMENDED

United Kingdom

74

AVEC · 25.5% net · BANKABLE

N°2

Germany

69

DFFF · 25% · BANKABLE

N°3

Georgia

61

GFIP · 20% · VERIFY FIRST

04, TERRITORY ANALYSIS

The ranked territories in depth

Full incentive, crew and infrastructure picture per territory.

N°1 · UNITED KINGDOM

74_{/100}

United Kingdom

Rebate	25.5% net (34% gross)
Est. rebate	£2,868,150
Payment	3 to 6 months
Crew depth tier	Extremely Established
Admin complexity	Medium

KEY ADVANTAGES

- The coastal town sequences that open and close the film are script-locked to the UK, making a UK anchor both creatively necessary and financially optimal.
- AVEC's 3 to 6 month payment window is the fastest of the three ranked territories, easing bridge financing pressure.

KEY RISKS

- Night-exterior permitting for the coastal chase sequence requires local council sign-off with variable lead times; apply early.

N°2 · GERMANY

69_{/100}

Germany

Rebate	25% (DFFF)
Est. rebate	€3,750,000
Payment	6 to 9 months
Crew depth tier	Established
Admin complexity	Medium

KEY ADVANTAGES

- Hamburg's working freight-port grants access rarely available elsewhere, suiting the interrogation sequence's authenticity requirements.
- DFFF's fixed 25% rate with a relatively low administrative bar suits a single-sequence co-shoot.

KEY RISKS

- DFFF operates on an annual fund allocation basis; confirm current-year fund availability before relying on this rebate in a financing document.

Georgia

Rebate	20% cash rebate
Est. rebate	See programme terms
Payment	6 to 9 months
Crew depth tier	Growing
Admin complexity	Medium-High

KEY ADVANTAGES

- Tbilisi's active rail-freight yards provide a genuine working environment for the chase sequence that would be costly to fabricate.
- Below-average below-the-line costs stretch the qualifying spend further than in either UK or German territories.

KEY RISKS

- Local production services registration must be completed before qualifying spend begins accruing; this has a lead time that should be started immediately if Georgia is confirmed.
- Crew depth is rated Growing rather than Established; specialist stunt-rigging crew may need to be imported.

05, FINANCIAL ANALYSIS

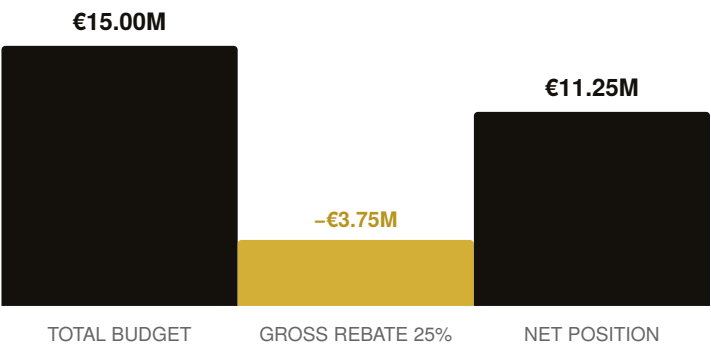
From budget to net position

One chart per ranked territory, every figure traceable to its working.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This is the section that turns a tax incentive rate into an actual number your financiers can put in a budget. A headline rate means nothing until you see it applied to real qualifying spend, with the caps and payment timing that decide whether a lender will advance against it before the money arrives.

REBATE WATERFALL, GERMANY · DFFF (GERMAN FEDERAL FILM FUND)



DFFF applies to qualifying German spend only, not the full production budget. Figure shown assumes the Hamburg sequence's full qualifying spend is incurred in-territory. Verify current-year fund allocation before modelling.

NET REBATE BY TERRITORY

United Kingdom	£2,868,150
Germany	€3,750,000
Georgia	See programme terms

WHEN THE MONEY ARRIVES, PAYMENT TIMING

United Kingdom	3 TO 6 MONTHS
Germany	6 TO 9 MONTHS
Georgia	6 TO 9 MONTHS

06, FINANCIAL READINESS

Can this be financed as planned?

Computed from the figures elsewhere in this report, against a fixed rule. Not a score, not an opinion.

VERDICT · UNITED KINGDOM · UK AVEC

CONDITIONAL

58

Weighted readiness score is 58/100. The plan holds together but carries conditions that must be resolved before financial close.

/ 100

HOW THIS IS ASSESSED

Four components, budget against the recommended territory's cost base, how much of the modelled incentive is confirmed rather than estimated, matched soft money as a share of budget, and whether the completion date survives the shoot schedule and incentive payment window, are each tested against the figures elsewhere in this report.

Budget against territory cost base

CONDITIONAL · 30% WEIGHT

Declared budget £15,000,000. Only 1 comparable production with a known budget was matched for the UK; at least 3 are required before a median is treated as a cost anchor.

- ✓ UK AVEC states no minimum qualifying spend, so there is no budget floor to clear.
- ! Only 1 comparable production matched; cost base anchor is unconfirmed.

Confirmed vs. estimated incentive value

READY · 30% WEIGHT

The £2,868,150 modelled incentive (19.1% of budget) meets every confirmation criterion.

- ✓ Producer qualifies outright.
- ✓ Bankability is 'Bankable'.

Timeline feasibility

CONDITIONAL · 25% WEIGHT

Declared shoot length is 9 weeks; script-implied shooting days suggest closer to 9.4 weeks, a narrow but workable margin. Georgia's 6 to 9 month payment window should be modelled into cash flow before financial close.

- ✓ UK incentive expected within the in-period threshold.
- ! Georgia payment window extends bridge financing requirement.

Soft-money coverage

CONDITIONAL · 15% WEIGHT

Matched soft money covers an estimated 3.2% of budget, below the 5% threshold at which it materially reduces the equity ask.

- ! Soft-money figures are maximum available awards on matched programmes, not committed funds.

Assessed on 11 August 2026. Re-run the report to reassess against current data. This is an assessment of the inputs held, not financial advice; verify with a production accountant and the relevant film commissions before financial close.

07, WEATHER & LOGISTICS

Shoot-window risk by territory

Climate data and travel practicalities for the ranked territories.

United Kingdom

MEDIUM RISK

Best months: April, May, June, September

Coastal night-exterior work carries meaningful weather exposure outside the April to September window; the chase sequence should be scheduled within this range to reduce delay risk.

Visas: crew from EU/EEA and US do not require a visa for short UK shoots; work authorisation required for commercial productions, apply through UK Home Office, allow 4 to 8 weeks.

Germany

LOW RISK

Best months: May, June, July, August

Hamburg's port-side night exteriors benefit from long summer daylight and comparatively low rainfall in this window, easing lighting and safety planning for the interrogation sequence.

Visas: Schengen visa-free entry applies to most Western producers for stays up to 90 days; local work permits required for employed crew, allow 4 to 6 weeks.

Georgia

VERIFY FIRST

Best months: May, June, September, October

Tbilisi's freight-yard exteriors are workable across most of the year but summer heat can affect crew endurance during long night shoots; early autumn is the recommended window.

Visas: many nationalities receive visa-free entry for short stays; crew work authorisation should be confirmed directly with the Georgian National Film Center given the working freight-yard access required.

08, TAX INCENTIVE ANALYSIS

Programme rates, caps and requirements

Verified programme data; low-confidence records are flagged, never presented as certainties.

United Kingdom, UK Audio-Visual Expenditure Credit (AVEC)

BANKABLE

25.5% net (34% gross) · Cap: No cap

£2,868,150 est. rebate Min. qualifying spend: **No minimum threshold** Payment: **3 to 6 months**

Standard AVEC rate applied at this budget level; the enhanced Independent Film Tax Credit rate does not apply as core expenditure exceeds the qualifying ceiling. Confirm cultural test pass with the BFI before relying on this figure.

Germany, DFFF (German Federal Film Fund)

BANKABLE

25% · Cap: €4M per project

€3,750,000 est. rebate Min. qualifying spend: **€200,000** Payment: **6 to 9 months**

DFFF operates on an annually replenished fund with a fixed allocation ceiling; applications are assessed on a rolling basis until the year's fund is exhausted. Confirm current-year fund status before financial close.

Georgia, Georgian Film Incentive Programme (GFIP)

VERIFY FIRST

20% cash rebate · Cap: No cap

See programme terms est. rebate Min. qualifying spend: **\$100,000** Payment: **6 to 9 months**

Format eligibility for this programme has not been independently verified beyond the published programme guidelines. Requires local production services company registration prior to spend. Confirm current rate and cap directly with the Georgian National Film Center before relying on this figure in a financing document.

Estimates only. Final eligibility depends on official approval by the relevant authorities.

09, GRANT & FUNDING OPPORTUNITIES

Matched funds and deadlines

Funds whose territory and format criteria this production meets.

BFI Film Fund, Production

Up to £1,000,000
rolling

United Kingdom · nationality restriction applies

United Kingdom is a ranked production territory; accepts drama, thriller

Film4 Production Fund

Up to £2,000,000
rolling

United Kingdom

United Kingdom is a ranked production territory; specifically funds feature projects with UK creative control

German Motion Picture Fund (GMPF)

Up to €2,000,000
rolling

Germany · co-production preferred

Germany is a ranked production territory for this project's Hamburg sequences

Creative Europe MEDIA, Development Single Project

Up to €60,000
2026-10-15

United Kingdom / Germany · **CLOSING SOON**

restricted to EU/eligible entities, a co-production structure would be required

10, COMPARABLE PRODUCTIONS

Films that made similar choices

Matched on genre, budget tier and territory relevance.

TITLE	GENRE	BUDGET	LOCATION	YEAR
Tinker Tailor Soldier Spy	Espionage, Drama	£15M–£20M	United Kingdom	2011
Bridge of Spies	Espionage, Drama	£30M+	Germany	2015

A UK-anchored espionage drama at a comparable budget tier, demonstrating that procedural, dialogue-driven thrillers of this scale can be produced efficiently on UK incentive terms.

A Berlin-set Cold War drama with substantial German location work, demonstrating the territory's established capacity for period-adjacent espionage production, albeit at a higher budget tier than this project.

11, FESTIVAL & DISTRIBUTOR RECOMMENDATIONS

Where your film could be seen, and who could buy it

Matched on format, timing, genre and territory, never inferred.

FESTIVALS

BFI London Film Festival

United Kingdom · A-List

Genre match: thriller, drama

Berlinale

Germany · A-List

Genre match: drama; strong fit given the Hamburg sequence

DISTRIBUTORS

StudioCanal

UK/Europe · all rights typical

Genre specialty match: thriller, drama. Distributes in production markets: United Kingdom, Germany

Vertigo Releasing

UK · theatrical

Genre specialty match: thriller

12, NEXT STEPS & DISCLAIMERS

What to do with this report

Territory-specific, deadline-anchored actions, then the legal frame.

- 1 Initiate UK night-exterior permit applications for the coastal chase sequence with the relevant local council. **(At least 8 weeks before shoot)**
- 2 Confirm current-year DFFF fund allocation status in Germany before relying on the €3,750,000 estimate in any financing document. **(Before financing close)**
- 3 Begin Georgian local production services company registration to start the qualifying spend clock ahead of the Tbilisi shoot window. **(Immediately, if Georgia is confirmed)**
- 4 Model Georgia's 6 to 9 month payment window into cash flow projections and arrange bridge financing accordingly. **(Before financial close)**
- 5 Source at least 2 further UK comparable productions with disclosed budgets to strengthen the cost-base anchor in Section 06. **(Before financing close)**

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